EXECUTIVE SUMMARY | Embassy Outreach Status

Position as of 06 October 2026 | 84 embassies, 6 regions | Source: cleaned database (91 raw rows, 7 duplicates removed)

EMBASSIES	ACTIVE OUTREACH	ENGAGED	OVERDUE	SILENT 90+ DAYS	RECORDS TO REVIEW
84	**59**	**19**	**30**	**13**	**53**
6 regions	70% of total	32% of active	51% of active	active embassies	63% have data gaps

KEY OBSERVATIONS

- **The pipeline is wide but shallow.** 59 of 84 embassies (70%) are in active outreach, but only 19 (32% of active) have reached Engaged. 10 are not started, 11 are On Hold (9 of them low engagement) and 4 are closed. 14 of the 15 embassies at Initial Contact were first contacted more than six months ago, so they appear stalled.
- **Follow-up discipline is the main weakness.** 30 of 59 active embassies (51%) are past their follow-up date, including 12 of the 19 Engaged embassies and 6 of 11 with a meeting scheduled. 13 active embassies have had no contact for 90+ days; Ethiopia and Russian Federation (both Engaged) have been silent for about seven months.
- **Regions differ sharply.** Sub-Saharan Africa has the best engagement (6 of 15 embassies Engaged, 40%) but 8 of its 10 active embassies are overdue (80%), so its strongest relationships are the most at risk of going cold. South & Central Asia is also at 80% (small base, 7 embassies). Europe is the largest region (21) with only 14% Engaged. Middle East & North Africa is the best on track (14% overdue).
- **Workload and ownership are uneven.** Priya Nair, Neha Kulkarni and Sameer Khan hold 20 of the 30 overdue follow-ups, while Rahul Verma has only 1 of 9 overdue. 8 embassies (5 of them active) have no owner at all.

DATA GAPS AND ISSUES

- **Duplicates:** 7 rows removed (4 exact, 3 near-duplicates re-entered under new IDs); 3 originals kept but the correct contact still needs confirming.
- **Reliability:** 53 of 84 records (63%) still carry a gap or conflict: 8 with no owner, 7 active embassies with no follow-up date, 7 where status contradicts recorded activity, 7 with impossible or future dates, 13 with a missing or invalid email, 12 with a phone gap, and 10 where engagement was not recorded.
- **Effect on the numbers:** overdue and silent counts are a *floor*, not an exact figure. Active embassies with no follow-up date cannot be flagged overdue, and future-dated contacts are excluded from the silent measure. Ghana's 331-day silence, for example, sits on a record with inconsistent dates.
- **Root cause:** free-text entry. The file held 15 spellings of 7 statuses, 10 region variants and text dates, with no mandatory fields.

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR MANAGEMENT

1. **Run a 30-day follow-up recovery.** Clear the 30 overdue items, starting with the 12 Engaged and 6 Meeting Scheduled embassies and the 13 silent ones. Owners report progress weekly from the dashboard.
2. **Fix ownership.** Assign an owner to the 8 unassigned embassies this week and rebalance load away from the three owners holding two-thirds of the overdue items.
3. **Prioritise by region and stage.** Protect momentum in Sub-Saharan Africa, decide whether Europe needs a push or a lower priority, set a rule for moving Initial Contact embassies forward, and decide whether to reactivate or close the 11 On Hold.
4. **Fix the data at source.** Make owner, next follow-up date and engagement level mandatory; use drop-downs for status, region and country; validate dates and IDs. Owners confirm the 18 high-severity records on the Data Quality Review worklist within a week.
5. **Make this a monthly review** with targets agreed by leadership (suggested: overdue below 10% of active, no active embassy silent beyond 90 days). The workbook updates from one as-of date on its Settings sheet.

Definitions: *Active* = Initial Contact, In Discussion, Meeting Scheduled or Engaged. *Overdue* = active embassy whose next follow-up date has passed. *Silent* = active embassy with no contact for over 90 days. Full detail in the Excel workbook (Dashboard and Data_Quality_Review sheets).

AI EXERCISE

How AI was used to support the analysis

1. AI TOOL USED

Claude (Anthropic), used through the claude.ai chat interface with file upload and code execution. It read the assessment brief and both Excel files, built and tested workbook formulas, and drafted written findings.

2. PROMPTS USED

Prompt 1 - Planning (brief and cleaned workbook attached): *"I'm doing an assessment on an embassy outreach database and need a leadership dashboard. Before we build anything, can you suggest a layout that covers what management asked for (status, data gaps, engagement by region and priorities) and tell me which KPIs you would pick and why?"*

Prompt 2 - Dashboard build: *"Okay, that structure works for me. Please build it on a new sheet with live formulas that pull only from the cleaned data, and let me change the as-of date and the 90-day silent limit myself. Add the KPIs, pipeline, region and owner tables, an overdue list and a few charts, then recalculate and tell me if anything breaks."*

Prompt 3 - Verification: *"Before I trust these numbers, can you recompute the main figures (active, engaged, overdue, silent) and the region and owner tables with a separate script and compare them to the workbook? Please tell me about any mismatch."*

Prompt 4 - Data quality review: *"I also need a data quality review. Can you group the problems you found, rate how serious each one is for reporting, and make sure the counts match the cleaning log? Please also list the most serious records the owners should check first, with a short summary I can read out."*

Prompt 5 - Writing: *"Now help me write it up. Using only the numbers we have verified, draft a one-page executive summary and this AI note for me to review. Keep every figure traceable, and tell me plainly where the data is too thin to say much."*

3. HOW AI ASSISTED

Stage	What AI did	How the output was checked
Planning	Read the brief and chose the dashboard structure: headline KPIs, key takeaways, pipeline and region views, owner workload, attention lists and a data quality snapshot.	Structure matched against the four goals in the management brief.
Dashboard build	Wrote 2,300+ live formulas and 4 charts in the workbook so every figure recalculates from the cleaned data and one as-of date.	Full recalculation returned 0 formula errors.
Verification	Recomputed the headline figures (active, overdue, silent, region and owner tables, data issue counts) with a separate script.	All figures matched the workbook exactly.
Data quality review	Classified 17 issue types by severity and reporting impact, and built a worklist of 18 high-severity records.	Counts tie to the Cleaning_Log; record details checked against Clean_Data.
Writing	Drafted the executive summary and this note from the verified figures.	Every number traced to the workbook.

4. INSIGHTS AND RECOMMENDATIONS GENERATED THROUGH AI

- **Engaged does not mean up to date:** 12 of the 19 Engaged embassies are past their follow-up date. This is easy to miss in a status count alone.
- **Stalled early pipeline:** 14 of 15 Initial Contact embassies were first contacted over six months ago, which suggests a missing rule for moving them forward.
- **Workload concentration:** three owners hold 20 of the 30 overdue follow-ups, pointing to a rebalancing need rather than a general discipline problem (one owner has just 1 overdue).
- **Channel pattern (indicative only):** Official Letter (5 of 12) and Phone (4 of 13) produce a higher share of High engagement than Email (4 of 24) or Meetings (1 of 14). Numbers are small and this shows association, not cause.
- **Data insight:** the longest silent embassy (Ghana, 331 days) sits on a record with date errors, so AI recommended confirming flagged records before acting on individual cases.
- **Recommendations** in the executive summary: recovery sprint, owner assignment and rebalancing, regional and stage prioritisation, mandatory fields and drop-downs, and a monthly review with agreed targets.

5. LIMITATIONS AND HUMAN JUDGEMENT

- Definitions of *active*, *overdue* and *silent* were proposed by AI and are editable inputs; leadership should confirm them. The 90-day silent threshold and the reporting date (06 Oct 2026) are assumptions held on the Settings sheet.
- AI could check format and consistency, not real-world accuracy: contacts, emails and phone numbers still need confirming with the owners.
- Severity ratings and the recommendations are judgement calls offered for management to accept or change; targets such as "overdue below 10%" are suggestions, not agreed standards.